GARSEF

9/2/26

GARSEF: Greater Austin Regional Science and Engineering Fair

- The Greater Austin Regional Science and Engineering Fair is one of Texas' largest regional science fairs with almost 3,000 students from 3rd through 12th grade.
- It encourages and rewards innovative student research and provides scientists, engineers and other professionals a chance to volunteer in the community
- Winning Junior/Senior Division projects advance to the Texas Science and Engineering Fair.
- Best of Fair Senior Division projects advance directly to the Regeneron International Science and Engineering Fair.

Categories (Click links for more info)

Animal Sciences (ANIM)

Behavioral and Social Sciences (BEHA)

Biochemistry (BCHM)

Biomedical and Health Sciences (BMED)

Cellular and Molecular Biology (CELL)

Chemistry (CHEM)

Computational Biology and Bioinformatics (CBIO) (NEW THIS YEAR)

Earth and Environmental Sciences (EAEV)

Embedded Systems (EBED)

Energy: Sustainable Materials and Design (EGSD)

Engineering Technology: Statics and Dynamics (ETSD)

Environmental Engineering (ENEV)

Materials Science (MATS)

Mathematics (MATH)

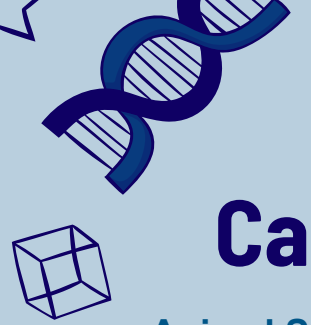
Microbiology (MCRO)

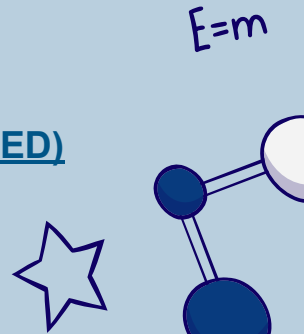
Physics and Astronomy (PHYS)

Plant Sciences (PLNT)

Systems Software (SOFT)

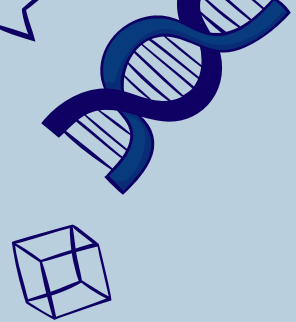
Translational Medical Science (TMED)





Click link to access rules

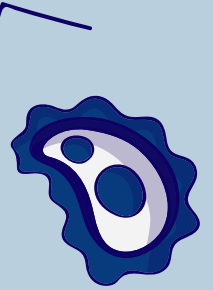
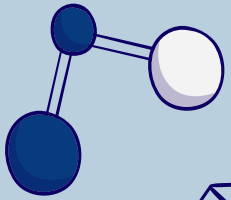
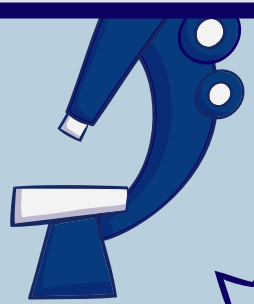
RULES



Timeline:

October 14, 2026	5:00 p.m.	Deadline to Open and Begin Student Registration in STEM Wizard. Students must complete the first two milestones by this date.
November 18, 2026	5:00 p.m.	Deadline to Complete Files and Forms in STEM Wizard. Students must complete all paperwork including required pre-approval signatures with the exception of the abstract and Form 1C (if required).
January 4, 2027	5:00 p.m.	The Abstract (in Files and Forms) and an Additional Information milestone will be added to STEM Wizard. These must be completed after experimentation and are due before January 15, 2027
January 21, 2027	5:00 p.m.	Deadline for Registration before SRC review. AI milestones must be complete with the exception of the Submissions for Judges Review. Teachers must deactivate students who are not competing by the deadline or they will be charged for the projects. Senior division teachers must submit plagiarism reports (abstracts and research plans).
February 5, 2026	5:00 p.m.	Deadline for Students to Upload Submissions for Judges Review in STEM Wizard. This is done after SRC approval.

PROJECT SET-UP/FAIR DAY



Fair Location

Palmer Events Center, 900 Barton Springs Road, South Lobby

Project Set-Up

Wednesday, February 17, 2026

2:30 p.m. – 7:00 p.m.

Parking is free.

FAIR DAY

Thursday, February 18, 2026

DURING THE SCHOOL DAY:

9:00 AM - 3:45 PM

Project Information

- Can be done by an Individual or a Team of up to 3 students
  - Must be selected when setting up account in STEM Wizard. This can't be changed.
- Compete in one of the 19 Scientific Categories
- Must abide by ISEF Rules and Guidelines
- May only contain one year of continuous research

Student Registration: Step 1

Go to the **STEM Wizard website** for your fair and select the Registration option. Student will be one of the options in the drop-down menu. If you have participated in GARSEF before, simply log in with your existing information, you don't need to register again.



Student Registration: Step 2

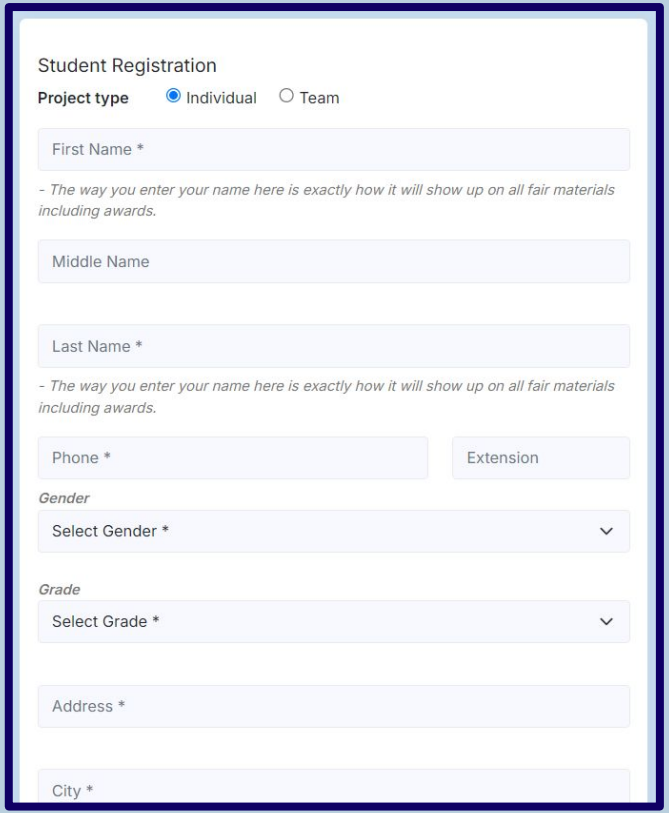
The Student Registration is fairly basic, including things like your name, address, username, etc.

You will first need to specify whether or not the project is an Individual Project or Team Project.

If you select Team, all team members will need to fill out their personal information such as name and address.

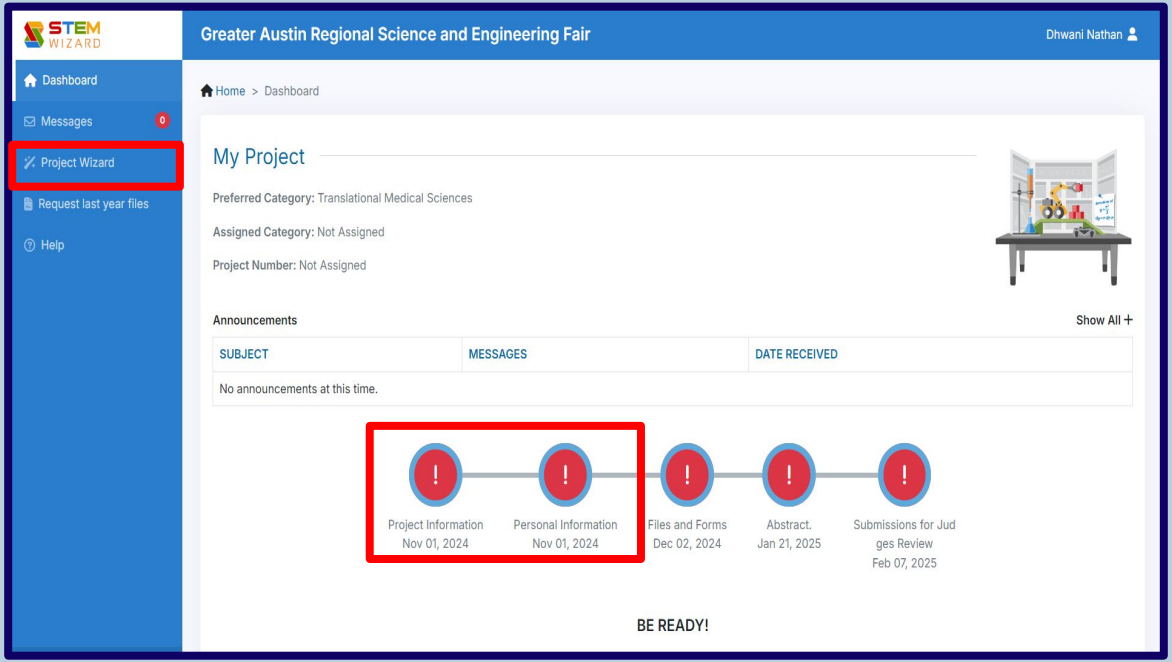
Please Note: Project Type (Individual/team) CANNOT be changed later.

The secondary email should be a parent's email that will also receive an email with the account details.



Student Registration: Step 3

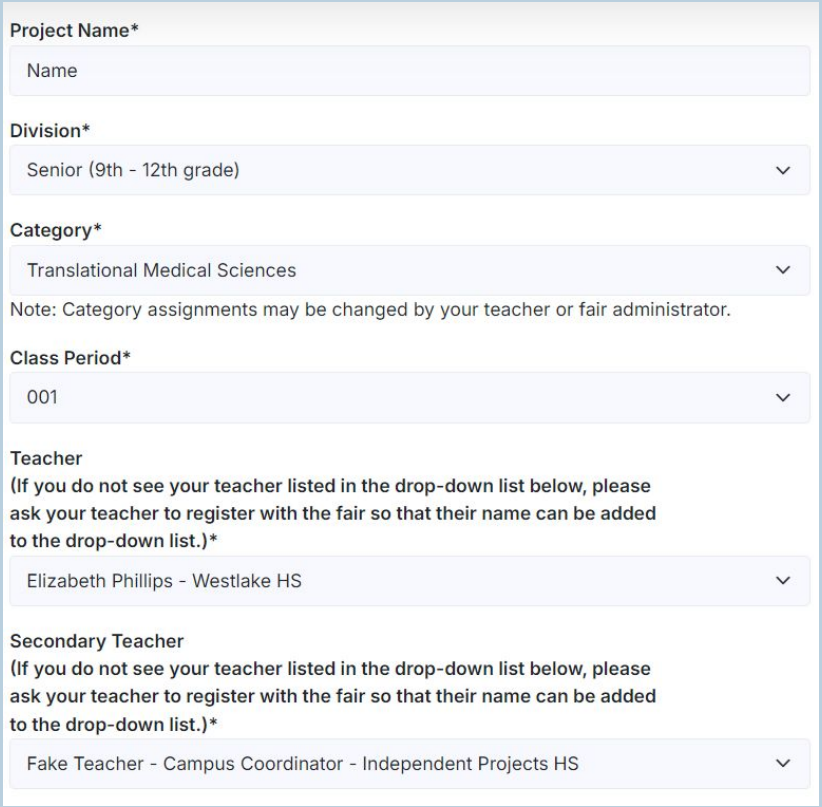
Log into your account and fill out your Project Information and your Personal Information.
Your Registration for the regional fair is not complete until you have completed all of your Milestones.
Make sure the first 2 milestones are completed before 5:00pm, October 14 2026



Student Registration: Step 4

Project Information

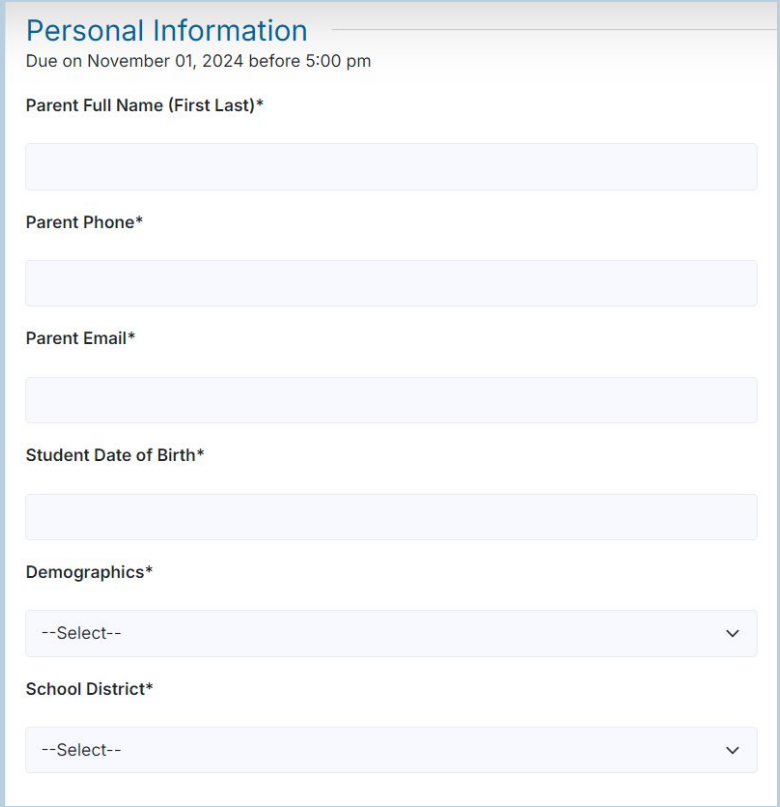
- Make sure you choose:
  - Senior Division (9th - 12th Grade)
  - Class Period 001
  - “Elizabeth Phillips - Westlake HS” as your teacher and “Fake Teacher - Campus Coordinator - Independent Projects HS” as the secondary teacher



Student Registration: Step 5

Personal Information

- Should look like this
- **Also should be completed by completed before 5:00pm, October 14 2026**



GARSEF Officers

Secretary/webmaster

Aarav Dhawan

Treasurer

Deven Kancherla

Vice President

Chris Wu

President

Dhwani Nathan

Officer Positions

Reach out if you would like an officer position! We are looking for sophomore and freshman representatives :)

More Club Info: Fees

There is a GARSEF Registration Fee of $25 for students participating in the fair, this will be charged at the end of the school year for all registered participants

More Club Info: Meetings

- Meetings will be held on Mondays, usually the first Monday of the month
- Some months do have more frequent meetings depending on how busy it is in terms of due dates, action items, etc.

- Future Meeting Dates (subject to change):
  - 10/7
  - 10/21
  - 11/4
  - 11/18
  - 12/2
  - 12/16
  - 1/6
  - 2/3
  - 2/10
- **NEXT MEETING ON MONDAY, OCTOBER 6th**



Questions?

Thank You!!